



# ANNUAL REPORT 2025-2026

Creating measurable impact at the

**Grass roots**

[www.rootsfoundation.in](http://www.rootsfoundation.in)



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# About Roots Foundation

Roots Foundation is a grassroots development organisation working across Sustainable Agriculture, Sports, Education, Skill Development, and Community Development.

Established with the belief that lasting change begins within communities, Roots Foundation designs and implements long-term interventions that are participatory, measurable, and rooted in local realities.

Our work focuses on strengthening systems that improve quality of life, expand opportunity, and enable communities to build sustainable futures with greater resilience and self-reliance.

Over the years, Roots Foundation has partnered with corporates, institutions, local governments, and community stakeholders to implement programs across multiple states in India, with a strong emphasis on execution, accountability, and measurable outcomes.



# Message From The Founders

At Roots Foundation, we have always believed that meaningful change begins at the grassroots. This year reaffirmed that belief as communities increasingly became active participants in shaping and strengthening the programs implemented alongside them.



Multiple States



Hundreds of Communities



100+ Partners



Year-round Engagement

Our focus has always been on creating programs that last beyond timelines and funding cycles. We invest time in building trust with communities and partners, understanding local realities, and designing implementation models that can sustain and grow over time. When communities take ownership, impact continues well beyond the duration of a project.

Transparency, accountability, and continuous learning remain central to how we measure and improve our work. Across our programs, we continue to strengthen collaboration with local administrations, institutions, and ecosystem partners to support long-term continuity and adoption.

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As Roots Foundation continues to grow, our commitment remains unchanged: to build programs that create measurable impact, strengthen local systems, and enable communities to shape their own progress with confidence and dignity.

**Ridhima & Ritwik Bahuguna**  
Founders, Roots Foundation



# Our impact by focus areas



-  Agriculture & Environment
-  Education & Career Rediness
-  Sports & Physical Literacy
-  Skill Development
-  Community Development



**AGRICULTURE AND ENVIRONMENT**  
Building Circular, Climate-Ready Farm Systems



**SPORTS & PHYSICAL LITERACY**  
Creating Grassroots Pathways to Sporting Excellence



**SKILL DEVELOPMENT**  
Linking Skills, Production and Livelihoods



**EDUCATION & CAREER READINESS**  
Strengthening Learning Pathways for Every Child



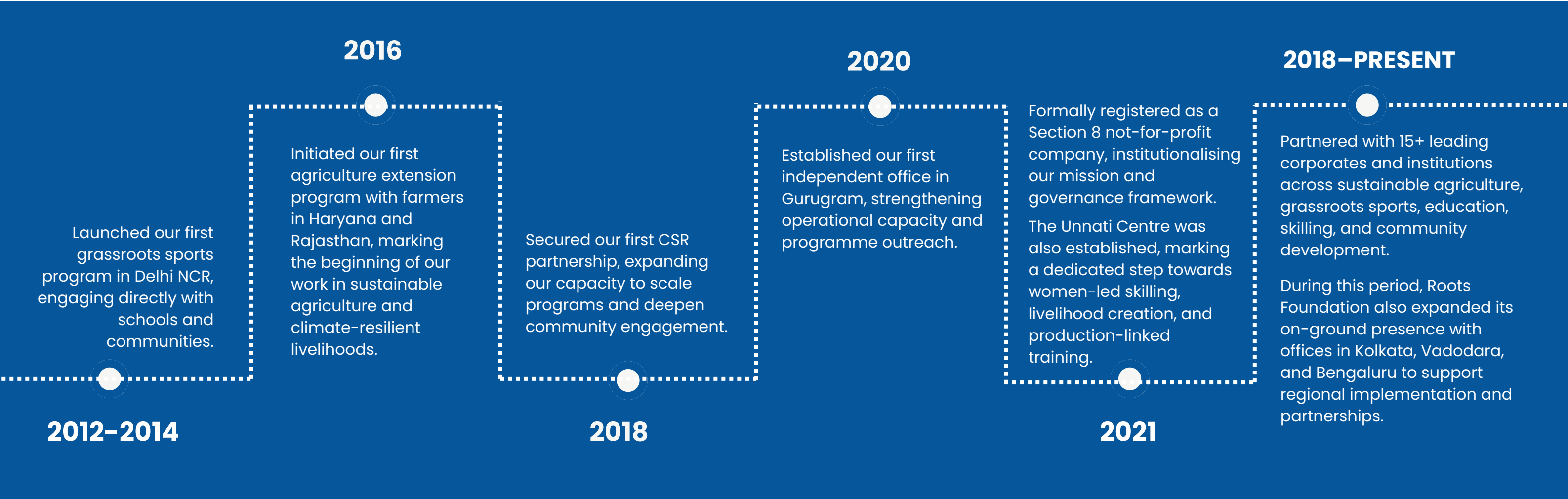
**COMMUNITY DEVELOPMENT**  
Creating Access Where Communities Need It Most

# OUR JOURNEY

Founded in 2012, Roots Foundation began with a simple conviction that lasting change must grow from the grassroots.

What started as a small, founder-funded initiative has evolved into a multi-sector organisation working across agriculture, education, sports, skill development, and community development.

Over the years, Roots Foundation has steadily expanded its reach across sectors and geographies, working alongside communities to strengthen local systems, support sustainable livelihoods, and build long-term development programs rooted in participation and continuity.







## Our Mission

To create equitable opportunities for individuals and communities through sustainable interventions in agriculture, sports, education, skilling, and community development.

## Our Vision

To strengthen grassroots communities through long-term, community-led programs that create measurable and sustained impact.

# Rooted In Impact

At Roots Foundation, impact is built through participation, continuity, and local ownership. Our programs are designed with communities, grounded in local realities, and implemented through long-term engagement.

Across sectors, we focus on strengthening systems that can sustain beyond the lifecycle of a project, whether through behaviour change, institutional partnerships, local capacity building, community development or livelihood creation.

### This approach shapes all our work:

|                                                                      |                                                        |                                                                                   |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Creating structured pathways in grassroots sports                    | Strengthening learning environments in schools         | Improving quality of life through integrated community development                |
| Supporting climate-resilient agriculture through farmer-led adoption | Connecting skilling with real livelihood opportunities | Advancing water conservation through lake rejuvenation and ecological restoration |

# Roots Foundation and Sustainable Development Goals

The Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) provide a shared global framework to address poverty, inequality, climate change, access to education, health, livelihoods, and sustainable development.

At Roots Foundation, our programs align with these goals through long-term, community-led interventions across agriculture, sports, education, skilling, and community development.

From strengthening climate-resilient farming systems and improving access to education, to creating livelihood opportunities and supporting grassroots sports ecosystems, our work contributes to multiple interconnected SDGs across people, planet, and prosperity.

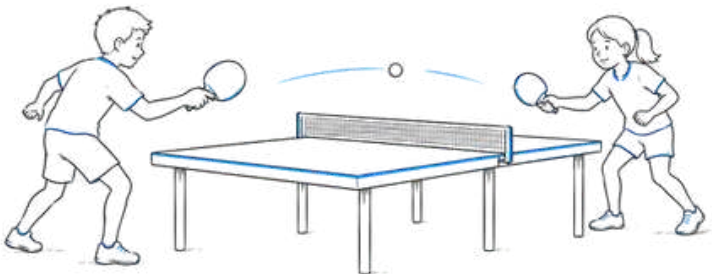


## Agriculture and Environment



Crop Residue Management (in-situ and ex-situ), Direct Seeding of Rice, crop diversification, agroforestry, farmer field schools, soil health improvement, biodiversity conservation, water-efficient practices, and market linkages for residue management that support climate-resilient agriculture.

## Sports & Physical Literacy



Grassroots sports programs, Centres of Excellence, talent scouting in remote regions, school and community leagues, sports-specific training, fitness and nutrition support, advocacy for equal opportunities, and structured pathways for young athletes from underserved communities.



## Skill Development



Market-linked skilling, artisan and women-led production systems, employee volunteer workshops, flexible training models for sole-earning women, and livelihood pathways that support dignified economic participation. The program also promotes circular economy approaches by using agricultural and factory waste, including parali and fabric waste, to create environmentally conscious end products.

## Education & Career Readiness



Foundational literacy and numeracy, STEM and digital learning, life skills, career guidance, teacher and SDMC capacity building, promotion of sports and co-curricular learning, library ecosystems, and improved school engagement for children and adolescents.

## Community Development



Rural healthcare access, scholarships, digital literacy, sanitation, community infrastructure, disability inclusion, mobility support, water conservation, lake rejuvenation, local participation platforms, and initiatives that improve everyday quality of life in rural communities.

## Partnerships & Monitoring



Long-term CSR partnerships, collaboration with local administrations and institutions, independent third-party assessments, monitoring and evaluation systems, documentation, and ecosystem-based implementation approaches that strengthen transparency, accountability, and continuity.

# Agriculture and Environment

Across regions, our work combines farmer engagement, field demonstrations, mechanisation support, ecosystem partnerships, and capacity building to strengthen the adoption of sustainable agricultural practices.



Roots Foundation’s agriculture programs enable large-scale adoption of climate-resilient farming practices by combining farmer engagement, mechanisation support, field demonstrations, and ecosystem linkages that strengthen resource efficiency and long-term rural livelihoods.

## Addressing Environmental and Economic Challenges

Our programs are designed to address both environmental and economic challenges through key sustainable approaches.



Crop Residue Management (CRM)



Direct Seeding of Rice (DSR)



Crop Diversification



Agroforestry



Farmer-led Service Ecosystems

The focus remains on enabling long-term adoption by strengthening local systems, improving access to knowledge and machinery, and building stronger linkages between farmers, institutions, service providers, and end-user industries.



Focus Areas



Crop Residue Management (CRM)



Direct Seeding of Rice (DSR)



Climate-resilient agriculture



Farm mechanisation & entrepreneurship



Soil health and water-efficient practices



Farmer capacity building & field demonstrations



Farmer Field Schools & ecosystem engagement



Market and end-user industry linkages

Agriculture Snapshot

2,00,000+

Acres brought under Crop Residue Management enabling large-scale prevention of stubble burning.

4,00,000+

Tonnes of paddy residue sustainably managed through ecosystem-led interventions.

50,000+

Farmers reached and sensitised via campaigns, field demonstrations, and ecosystem engagement.

5.5 Lakh

Tonnes of CO2 emissions avoided equivalent to removing ~1.25 lakh cars from roads annually.

35%

Higher net returns per acre achieved through Direct Seeded Rice (DSR) compared to traditional methods.

10-12 Cr

Irrigation water saved through successful DSR adoption across Haryana.

240

Demonstration plots successfully validated DSR adoption across Haryana.

64

Boom sprayers deployed under Project Sahyog across four states.

27,760

Acres covered through mechanised spraying improving timeliness and precision.

20,000+

Labour-hours saved reducing drudgery and improving operational efficiency.

100+

Rural agripreneurs identified and enabled creating decentralised farm service ecosystems.

14+

End User Industry (EUI) linkages established strengthening market connections and value chains.





## PROJECT BHOOMI, HARYANA

Project Bhoomi Haryana focuses on reducing crop residue burning and strengthening climate-resilient agricultural practices across Fatehabad, Jind, Hisar, and Sonapat districts of Haryana.

The program combines Direct Seeding of Rice (DSR), Crop Residue Management (CRM), farmer sensitisation, stakeholder engagement, and ecosystem linkages to support long-term behavioural change and sustainable farming adoption.

### Key Interventions

- **Direct Seeding of Rice (DSR) Promotion:** Establishment of 240+ demonstration plots across districts, supported by soil testing, field-level advisory, and farmer handholding to validate cost-effective and scalable alternatives to traditional paddy cultivation.
- **Crop Residue Management (CRM) Ecosystem Enablement:** Large-scale farmer sensitisation and linkage with service providers, machinery operators, and end-user industries to enable in-situ and ex-situ residue management across districts.
- **Behaviour Change & Farmer Engagement:** Intensive village-level campaigns, demonstrations, and continuous engagement to shift farmer practices away from burning towards sustainable alternatives.
- **Ecosystem & Market Linkages:** Integration of farmers with service providers, FPOs, agricultural departments, and end-user industries to create a functional and scalable residue management value chain.

### Highlights & Outcomes

- **Direct Seeding of Rice (DSR)** validated as a scalable and profitable alternative, with demonstration plots delivering 35% higher income
- Adoption pipeline established, with **300+** farmers adopting DSR and **1,500+** farmers identified for scale-up in the next season
- **30,000+** farmers enabled with access to Crop Residue Management (CRM) solutions, linking them to service providers and viable alternatives to burning
- District-level CRM value chain activated, integrating **8 End User Industries (EUIs)** for large-scale residue utilisation
- **36,000+** farmers influenced through structured behaviour change campaigns, contributing to reduction in fire-prone practices across intervention areas
- Integrated CRM ecosystem operationalised across **4 districts**, aligning farmers, machinery providers, institutions and markets into a scalable system







## PROJECT BHOOMI, KOTA

Project Bhoomi Kota focuses on developing local entrepreneurship models for crop residue management and sustainable mechanisation practices in Rajasthan, with a unique focus on both the Kharif and Rabi cycles. The program is designed to address the critical gap in Rabi residue management, where burning remains largely unaddressed. The initiative works towards building a self-sustaining ecosystem where rural youth and farmers can access machinery, residue utilisation networks, and livelihood opportunities linked to sustainable agricultural practices.

### Key Interventions

- **Kharif CRM Awareness & System Preparation:** Farmer sensitisation and ecosystem groundwork to prepare villages for structured residue management interventions
- **Rural Agripreneurship Development for CRM Services:** Identification and onboarding of local entrepreneurs to enable machinery-led service delivery
- **Mechanisation Enablement & Demonstration:** Introduction of Super Seeders, Zero Till Seeders, and balers in regions with minimal existing infrastructure
- **Rabi CRM Awareness & Behaviour Change Campaigns:** Targeted engagement to address the largely ignored Rabi burning cycle and build early adoption
- **Fire Season Response:** Activation of on-ground systems during the burning season to enable real-time intervention and demonstrate alternatives
- **Local CRM Ecosystem Creation:** Establishment of residue utilisation linkages with gaushalas, biomass units, and local traders
- **Farmer Engagement & Behaviour Change:** Direct farmer outreach to initiate adoption and build long-term behavioural shifts

### Highlights & Outcomes



First-of-its-kind dual-season **CRM model** initiated, addressing both Kharif preparedness and the largely neglected Rabi burning cycle



**46** rural agripreneurs identified to anchor last-mile service delivery, forming the foundation for a decentralised mechanisation model



**Mechanisation** introduced in low-infrastructure geographies, enabling first-time access to residue management solutions at village level like Balers and Superseeders



**Fire-season interventions** initiated during Rabi cycle, demonstrating practical alternatives to burning in real-time field conditions



**1,700+** farmers directly engaged, building early awareness, trust, and adoption momentum across villages



**Residue utilisation pathways** established, with gaushalas, traders, and biomass units integrated into the ecosystem







## PROJECT SAHYOG

Project Sahyog is a precision agriculture and farm mechanisation initiative implemented across Haryana, Punjab, Uttar Pradesh, and Uttarakhand. The program strengthens access to mechanised spraying systems while promoting safe agrochemical practices, entrepreneurship, and rental-based service models for farmers and rural institutions.

### Key Interventions

- **Precision Spraying Infrastructure Deployment:** Deployment of Tractor-Mounted Sprayers (TMS) and Self-Propelled Boom Sprayers (SPBS) to enable efficient, large-scale spraying
- **Agripreneurship & Rental Model Enablement:** Identification of entrepreneurial farmers, FPOs, cooperatives, and institutions to operate as service providers
- **Farmer Engagement & Field Demonstrations:** Engagement through demonstrations, FGDs, trainings, and awareness campaigns to build trust and drive adoption of mechanised spraying
- **Safe Agrochemical Use & Capacity Building:** Training on calibrated spraying, dosage optimisation, and safe handling practices
- **Mechanisation-led Service Delivery Systems:** Establishment of rental-based models to provide affordable and timely spraying services to small and marginal farmers

### Highlights & Outcomes



**64** boom sprayers deployed across Haryana, Punjab, Uttar Pradesh, and Uttarakhand, establishing a distributed precision spraying network at scale



**27,760 acres** covered through mechanised spraying in a single season



**1,818 farmers** directly accessed mechanised spraying services, reducing dependence on manual labour and high-cost alternatives



**15,000+ farmers** reached through demonstrations, FGDS, and awareness activities



**220** focussed group discussions conducted across project villages



**Video tutorials and operational training** provided to all machine beneficiaries for long-term usage support



**Rental-based agripreneur model** operationalised, enabling farmers and institutions to generate income through service delivery



**Safe agrochemical practices** promoted at scale, improving input efficiency and reducing overuse and health risks



**20,000+ labour**-hours saved, reducing drudgery and improving operational efficiency



**~150** workers safeguarded from direct agrochemical exposure





# Sports and Physical Literacy

Roots Foundation’s sports programs focus on creating structured pathways that enable children and young athletes to access training, mentorship, competitive exposure, and long-term development opportunities.

Across schools, communities, and Centres of Excellence, our programs work to strengthen grassroots participation, improve access to organised sport, and support athlete progression through ecosystem-based interventions. The approach combines physical literacy, coaching support, fitness and nutrition, talent scouting, sports science, parent engagement, and institutional partnerships to build sustainable sporting environments for children and youth.

The focus remains on creating continuity in athlete development while ensuring that children from rural, tribal, and underserved communities have access to opportunities that support both sporting and personal growth.



## Our Focus

Creating continuity in athlete development while ensuring that children from rural, tribal, and underserved communities have access to opportunities that support both sporting and personal growth.



Reaching rural, tribal & underserved communities



Ensuring continuity in athlete development pathways



Enabling holistic growth through sport and life skills





# Focus Areas



Grassroots sports promotion & participation



Structured athlete development pathways



Talent scouting & identification



School and community sports ecosystems



Centres of Excellence & residential training



Fitness, nutrition & sports science support



Coach development & mentorship



Parent & community engagement



Competitive exposure & athlete progression

# Sports Snapshot

10,000+

children engaged across grassroots sports programs, school initiatives, leagues, and athlete development pathways.

Structured

sports programs implemented across schools, villages, and Centres of Excellence.

Multi-sport

engagement across athletics, football, cricket, kho-kho, and other disciplines.

5,000

students reached through scouting initiatives across 450+ schools and 6 blocks under Project Utkarsh.

Residential

athlete development and progression pathways supported for selected athletes under Project Utkarsh.

Centres of Excellence

established under Sports Lab to support structured athlete development and long-term training ecosystems.

181

students engaged across three schools under Sports for All, with progression into state and national-level competitions.

450+

Schools

and 6 blocks covered through scouting initiatives under Project Utkarsh.

Pathways

Building a strong pipeline from grassroots to elite-level opportunities.







# SPORTS LAB

Sports Lab is Roots Foundation’s long-term athlete development initiative designed to strengthen grassroots sports ecosystems through structured training environments, Centres of Excellence, sports science integration, and athlete progression pathways. The program works with young athletes, coaches, schools, and communities to create sustained engagement in sport while supporting physical development, competitive readiness, and long-term participation.

## Key Interventions

- Establishment of Centres of Excellence for structured athlete development
- Athlete scouting and assessment processes
- Sports-specific coaching and training programs
- Integration of fitness, nutrition, recovery, and sports science support
- Parent engagement and athlete counselling sessions
- School and community-level engagement activities
- Monitoring and digital athlete tracking systems



## Highlights & Outcomes



**Centres of Excellence operationalised** to support structured athlete pathways



**Athlete engagement programs** conducted with schools, communities, and ecosystem partners



**Parent engagement** initiatives strengthened communication between athletes, coaches, and families



**Fitness, nutrition, and performance-focused support** integrated into athlete development systems



**Structured systems** introduced to support continuity in athlete training and progression







# SEHATGIRI

Sehatgiri is Roots Foundation's community wellness initiative that promotes healthy lifestyles through physical activity, preventive healthcare, and nutrition awareness. The programme encourages people of all age groups to adopt active lifestyles while strengthening community participation in health and fitness.

## Key Interventions

- Community fitness sessions.
- Wellness and health awareness campaigns.
- Preventive health initiatives.
- Physical activity promotion.
- Community engagement events.



## Highlights & Outcomes



Reached **4,000+** community members across urban Gurugram.



Conducted **22+** wellness and fitness sessions/events.



Increased awareness of preventive healthcare and healthy lifestyles.



Promoted regular physical activity and community well-being.



Encouraged healthier lifestyle choices through community engagement.







# GRASSROOTS SPORTS DEVELOPMENT PROGRAMME

ANUKURA is the flagship CSR sports initiative of Mahanadi Coalfields Limited (MCL), implemented by Roots Foundation in partnership with the District Administration, Mayurbhanj, Odisha. The programme aims to strengthen the grassroots sports ecosystem by promoting physical fitness, identifying sporting talent, and creating structured athlete development pathways for rural children and youth.

## Key Interventions

- Implemented across 30 Government Schools.
- Covering Baripada, Thakurmunda, and Moroda blocks.
- Establishing 12 Sports Training Centres across 48 villages.
- Developing 2 Centres of Excellence (CoEs).
- Scientific fitness assessments.
- Talent identification camps.
- Morning fitness programmes.
- Structured coaching.
- Career guidance and community engagement.

## Highlights & Outcomes



Reaching **3,600+** children and youth.



Expanded access to quality sports coaching across rural communities.



Established a structured grassroots sports ecosystem.



Created athlete pathways towards district, state and national competitions



Promoted lifelong fitness, sporting excellence, and community participation.







# SPORTS FOR ALL

Sports for All focuses on increasing access to organised sports participation among school-going children through structured school engagement, coaching support, competitions, and physical literacy programs. The initiative works closely with schools, students, and local stakeholders to strengthen sports participation while supporting confidence, teamwork, discipline, and school engagement among children.

## Key Interventions

- School-based sports coaching and engagement
- Grassroots competitions and tournament participation
- Physical literacy and fitness-focused activities
- Identification of promising athletes for higher-level participation
- Engagement with teachers, schools, and local communities
- Promotion of equal participation opportunities for girls and underserved children



## Highlights & Outcomes



**181** unique students participated across three schools under the program



**37** students advanced to state-level competitions



**3** students advanced to national-level competitions



**19** gold, **4** silver, **6** bronze medals secured across competitions



Participation enabled through platforms **including SGFI National School Games and KKFI National Kho-Kho Championship.**







# VILLAGE CHAMPIONS LEAGUE (VCL)

Village Champions League (VCL) is an innovative grassroots sports league designed to improve school attendance, youth leadership, and community participation through structured competitive sports. By integrating education with sport, VCL creates sustained engagement among students while promoting teamwork, discipline, and leadership.

## Key Interventions

- Structured Football and Kabaddi leagues.
- Attendance-linked participation.
- Community mobilisation.
- Leadership and life-skills development.
- Sports incentives and recognition.



## Highlights & Outcomes

-  **330+** students participated.
-  Covered **8** Government Schools across **6** villages.
-  Formed **16 teams**.
-  Conducted **138** competitive matches.
-  Created a prize pool of **₹13.18 lakh**.
-  Improved school attendance by **10.5%**.
-  Strengthened community participation and youth leadership through sport.







# PROJECT UTKARSH

Project Utkarsh focuses on identifying and supporting sporting talent from rural and tribal communities through structured scouting, residential training support, mentorship, and competitive exposure. The program is designed to create long-term athlete development pathways for children who often have limited access to organised sports infrastructure and training opportunities.

## Highlights & Outcomes



**5,000** students reached through scouting across **450+** schools and **6** blocks



**100** students selected for advanced support and structured athlete development



**13** students progressed to higher Centres of Excellence



Athletes participated in district, state, and **national-level** competitions across football, hockey, and athletics



**Structured support** provided through coaching, nutrition, physiotherapy, counselling, education continuity, and exposure opportunities.

## Key Interventions

- Large-scale talent scouting across schools and rural communities
- Athlete selection and residential training support
- Sports-specific coaching and competitive preparation
- Integration of education, counselling, nutrition, and mentorship
- Exposure visits and participation in district, state, and national competitions
- Continuous athlete monitoring and progression support





# Skill Development

Roots Foundation’s skilling programs focus on creating livelihood pathways that combine practical training, production-based learning, and long-term economic participation for women and youth.



**Market-Linked Training**  
Courses designed with local needs & industry insights to build relevant skills.



**Hands-on Learning**  
Practical, flexible & accessible learning environments.



**Real Production Connection**  
Training linked to real production systems & livelihood opportunities.



**Industry Engagement**  
Strong linkages with industry for exposure, internships, and orders.



**Livelihood & Empowerment**  
Enhanced employability, confidence, & financial independence.

Across schools, communities, and Centres of Excellence, our programs work to strengthen grassroots participation, improve access to organised sport, and support athlete progression through ecosystem-based interventions. The approach combines physical literacy, coaching support, fitness and nutrition, talent scouting, sports science, parent engagement, and institutional partnerships to build sustainable sporting environments for children and youth.

Through partnerships with brands, organisations, and industry stakeholders, the programs also create opportunities for women artisans and trainees to participate in professional production processes, workshops, and collaborative projects.





# Focus Areas



Women-led livelihood programs



Market-linked skilling



Production-based learning models



Artisan development and quality systems



Textile and embroidery training



Flexible learning and work environments



Industry and brand collaborations



Employment & entrepreneurship pathways

# Skilling Snapshot

## Livelihood & skilling programs

implemented for women and youth across community settings.

## Training provided

in sewing, embroidery, textile-based production, and related skills.

## Production-linked work opportunities

enabled through industry and brand collaborations.

## Rs 8 lakh

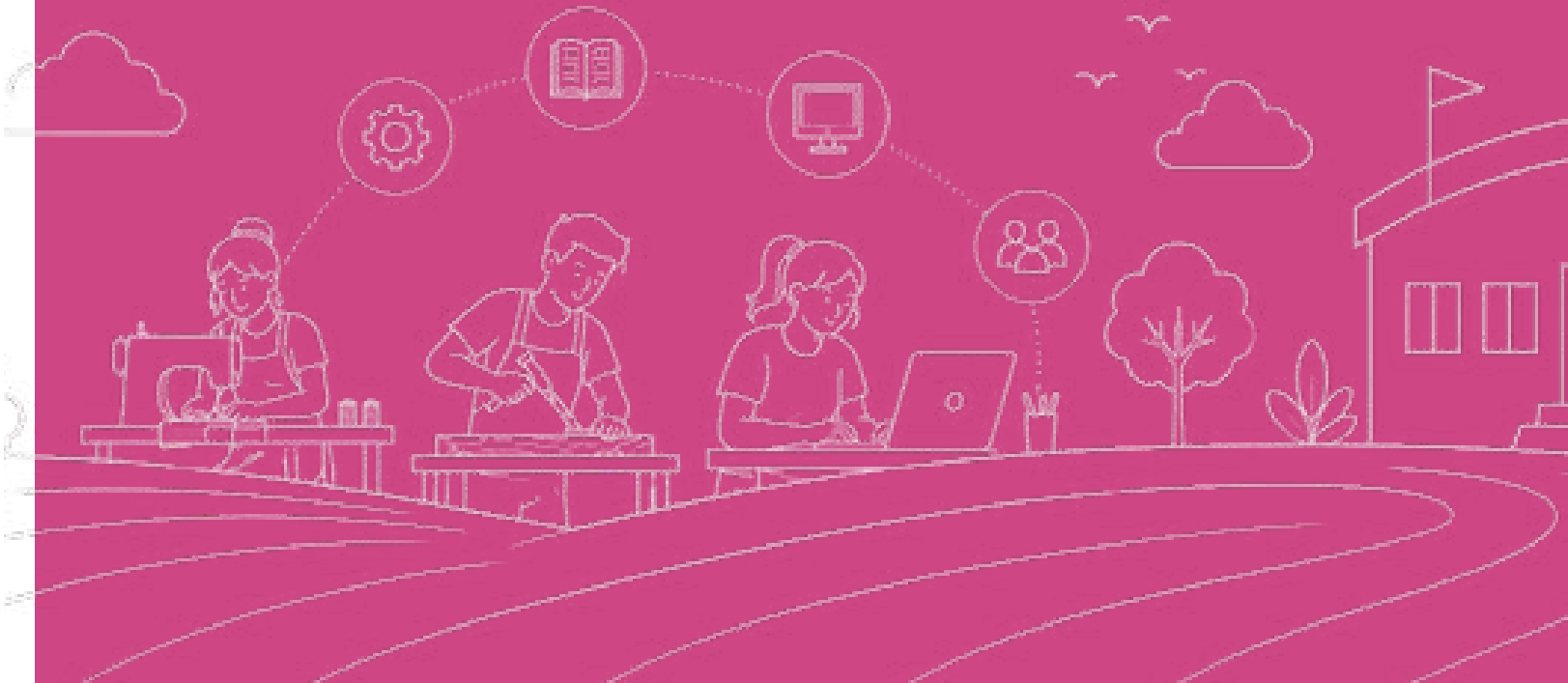
worth of work orders secured through production partnerships.

## Collaborations undertaken

with brands and organisations including Dressfolk, Amala Earth, Saffron House, Raghavendra Rathore, Aseem Design Studio, and Skinvest.

## Employee engagement

and artisan-led workshops conducted through hands-on production and design activities.







## PROJECT UNNATI

Project Unnati focuses on strengthening livelihood opportunities for women through skill development, production-based learning, and industry-linked engagement in textiles and embroidery.

The program creates accessible training and work environments that support women in building practical skills while participating in real production systems and collaborative projects. Alongside technical training, the initiative focuses on confidence-building, financial independence, and long-term livelihood continuity.

### Key Interventions

- Training in sewing, hand embroidery, machine embroidery, and textile production
- Production-linked learning through live work orders and collaborative projects
- Quality control and production management exposure for trainees
- Industry and brand collaborations for product development and execution
- Flexible work and learning models designed around local realities and responsibilities
- Employee engagement workshops were conducted to bring employees closer to the work being done under the skilling programs and the Unnati Centre. These included hands-on sessions where employees engaged with trainees, learned about production processes, and participated in activities related to textile work, upcycling, embroidery, and product creation.



### Highlights & Outcomes



**₹8 lakh** worth of work orders secured through collaborative production projects



**Women** are increasingly engaged in in-house production opportunities linked to the centre



**Collaborative production** and engagement initiatives undertaken with multiple independent brands and design studios



**Exposure** to quality control, product finishing, and production workflows integrated into training systems



**Artisan-led workshops** conducted with organisations and employee groups through hands-on learning experiences





Participant Journeys



Poonam  
Tiwari

Poonam Tiwari progressed from trainee to production team member through her involvement in embroidery and collaborative order execution at the centre. She also contributed to quality control processes during the Skinvest production project, strengthening both technical and operational skills.



Rannu  
Devi

Through training in Adda embroidery and continued engagement with the centre, Rannu Devi developed advanced embroidery skills while rebuilding confidence and financial stability during a period of personal and family challenges.



Divya  
Kumari

Divya Kumari strengthened her technical & professional skills through portfolio development & training support, eventually progressing toward formal employment opportunities while continuing to support long-term aspirations for herself & her family.



PROJECT PARALI

The Parali Project supports women from Self-Help Groups (SHGs) in creating marketable products from paddy residue. The initiative promotes circular economy practices by converting agricultural waste into environmentally conscious end products, while enabling women to build new skills, explore supplementary income opportunities, and participate in sustainable production systems.

Through training, product development, and market linkage support, the initiative connects crop residue management with women-led livelihood creation.





# Education & Career Readiness



Roots Foundation’s education programs focus on strengthening learning environments through foundational learning, adolescent development, school engagement, and holistic support systems for children and young people.

Across schools and communities, the programs work towards improving learning outcomes, confidence, retention, life skills, and access to meaningful educational opportunities. The approach combines foundational literacy and numeracy, STEM and digital learning, counselling support, career guidance, teacher engagement, and co-curricular development to create more inclusive and supportive learning ecosystems.



**Foundational Literacy**

The approach combines foundational literacy and numeracy.



**STEM & Digital Learning**

The approach combines STEM and digital learning.



**Counselling Support**

The approach combines counselling support.



**Career Guidance**

The approach combines career guidance.



**Teacher Engagement**

The approach combines teacher engagement.



**Co-curricular Development**

The approach combines co-curricular development.

The focus remains on enabling children and adolescents to participate more confidently in education while strengthening the broader systems that support their learning and development.





# Focus Areas



Foundational literacy and numeracy (FLN)



STEM & digital learning



Adolescent development & life skills



Career guidance and counselling



Teacher & school ecosystem strengthening



Holistic learning environments



School engagement and retention



Sports and co-curricular participation



Community & institutional engagement

# Education Snapshot

## 2 Major

targeted and structured education programs implemented across schools and community learning environments

## Foundational Learning

and adolescent development initiatives conducted through school-based interventions

## STEM, Digital Learning & Life Skills

engagement integrated into education programs

## Counselling, Mentorship & Career Guidance

support provided for adolescents and students

## Teacher Engagement & School Ecosystem Strengthening

supported through training and institutional collaboration across 22 low-income private and government schools in 5 cities, 4 states

## Focus on

improving participation, confidence, retention, and long-term learning continuity for children and adolescents

## Strengthening the Future

enabling children and adolescents to build skills, aspiration, and opportunities for a better tomorrow







## PROJECT LEAP

LEAP focuses on adolescent development through structured interventions in life skills, counselling, career guidance, leadership development, and school engagement. The program works with adolescents in school settings to strengthen confidence, communication, decision-making, and preparedness for future educational and personal pathways. Alongside group sessions and school engagement, the initiative provides individual counselling and support systems for students who require additional guidance.

### Key Interventions

- Life-skills and leadership development sessions
- Career guidance and future-readiness workshops
- Financial literacy and communication sessions
- One-on-one counselling and psychosocial support
- Capacity building, infrastructure improvement, and literacy-building engagement with schools, teachers, and local stakeholders
- Adolescent-focused workshops to strengthen confidence, participation, and self-awareness



### Highlights & Outcomes



**170+** life-skills and leadership development sessions conducted



**90+** workshops facilitated for career guidance and future readiness



**200+** financial literacy and communication workshops conducted



One-on-one counselling and psychosocial support extended to **8,300+** students



Structured engagement conducted across **22** schools, including work with teachers and local stakeholders



**50+** adolescent-focused workshops conducted to strengthen confidence and participation



**Counselling support** systems established to address student wellbeing and individual guidance needs



**Career awareness** & preparedness activities conducted for adolescents transitioning into higher education & future pathways



**Strengthened focus** on confidence building, participation, and long-term personal development







## STELLANTIS SCHOOL TRANSFORMATION PROJECT

The Stellantis School Transformation Project focuses on strengthening school ecosystems through foundational learning, STEM education, infrastructure support, and improved learning environments with a special focus on the girl child. The program works across partner schools to improve foundational literacy and numeracy, strengthen access to learning resources, and create supportive school environments that encourage participation, retention, and long-term educational engagement.

### Key Interventions

- Foundational literacy and numeracy (FLN) assessments and interventions
- STEM learning through set up science labs, experienced STEM trainers and digital learning engagement
- School infrastructure and learning environment support
- Teacher and school ecosystem engagement
- Support for girl child education and participation
- Portable STEM learning systems and activity-based learning approaches



### Highlights & Outcomes



Baseline evaluations completed across **4 partner schools** to assess foundational learning levels and learning gaps



**FLN-focused** interventions across **4 schools** initiated to strengthen reading, comprehension, and foundational learning outcomes



**All four schools** for the FLN intervention are equipped with state-of-the-art digital infrastructure and customised digital FLN teaching modules



**10 STEM labs** set up through permanent and portable models along with activity-based learning systems



Focus on strengthening **participation and learning** continuity for girls through improved school environments



**Teacher engagement** and ecosystem strengthening integrated into implementation planning and delivery







# SCHOOL TRANSFORMATION PROJECT WITH SPECIAL FOCUS ON EMPOWERING THE GIRL CHILD, HOSUR

A school transformation initiative in Hosur, Tamil Nadu, focused on improving foundational learning, STEM education, and school infrastructure for over 3,000 underprivileged children, with a special emphasis on empowering girls and students from Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribe communities.

## Key Interventions

- Implemented across 13 government schools in Thally and Kelamangalam blocks, Hosur.
- Benefiting 3,000+ students, with a special focus on girls and tribal communities.
- Establishing 3 Innovative Learning Centres (ILCs) to strengthen foundational literacy and numeracy.
- Setting up 10 STEM Labs to promote experiential science and technology education.
- Upgrading school infrastructure, including toilets and essential facilities, to improve hygiene, safety, and school retention.
- Delivering structured programmes in functional English, Mathematics, STEM, sanitation, and hygiene.



## Highlights & Outcomes



Improved foundational literacy, numeracy, and STEM learning among students.



Increased access to technology-enabled and experiential education.



Enhanced school infrastructure, contributing to better attendance and retention of girl students.



Reduced educational barriers for underserved children from Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribe communities.



Created safer, more inclusive, and equitable learning environments that support long-term educational success.





# Community Development

Roots Foundation’s community development programs focus on strengthening everyday systems that improve the quality of life across rural and underserved communities.

The approach combines healthcare access, infrastructure support, digital literacy, education assistance, livelihood initiatives, and community participation to address interconnected local needs through long-term engagement. Programs are designed to strengthen local ecosystems while improving access to essential services, public spaces, and opportunities for individuals and families.

Across geographies, the focus remains on building practical, community-centred interventions that support continuity, participation, and local ownership.



**Healthcare Access**  
Improving access to quality healthcare & essential health services.



**Infrastructure Support**  
Enhancing infrastructure and public spaces for safer, healthier communities.



**Digital Literacy**  
Building digital skills and enabling access to technology & information.



**Education Assistance**  
Supporting learning opportunities and academic growth for children and youth.



**Livelihood Initiatives**  
Creating sustainable livelihood opportunities and strengthening economic resilience.



**Community Participation**  
Encouraging active community involvement and local leadership for lasting impact.





# Focus Areas



Rural healthcare access



Community infrastructure development



Scholarships and education support



Digital literacy and community learning



Livelihood and self-help group engagement



Disability inclusion and mobility support



Public space and environmental restoration



Community participation and local systems strengthening

# Community Development Snapshot

## Karnataka & Tamil Nadu

Community development programs implemented across Karnataka and Tamil Nadu.

## Rural Integrated

Rural healthcare, infrastructure, and livelihood interventions conducted through integrated community engagement.

## Community Clinics: 2

Healthcare consultations, preventive care, and wellness support enabled through 2 major rural community clinics in Polanahalli and Cheemachanahalli, Karnataka.

## 30 Students

Scholarships to 30 deserving students from socially vulnerable backgrounds, along with digital literacy and community learning initiatives supported across intervention regions.

## Community Participation

Community participation and environmental sustainability integrated through local engagement, committees, and stakeholder coordination.

## 32.5 Acres

Successful rejuvenation of a 32.5-acre lake, restoring its ecological and functional value.

## 2 KM Road

Renovation of a ~2 km road from Kallupalli Gate to Atthipalli Main Road that benefits commute for approximately 5000 daily commuters.

## Public Infrastructure

Public infrastructure and ecological restoration projects implemented to strengthen long-term community access and usability.







# COMMUNITY DEVELOPMENT INITIATIVE, DEVANAHALLI

The Devanahalli Community Development Initiative focuses on strengthening access to healthcare, education support, digital learning, livelihoods, and basic community infrastructure across rural communities in Karnataka. The program works through integrated interventions designed to improve everyday quality of life while supporting long-term community participation and local engagement.

## Key Interventions

- Rural healthcare and preventive care support through community clinics
- Scholarships and educational support initiatives
- Digital literacy and community learning activities
- Livelihood and self-help group engagement
- Community infrastructure support including lighting and public-use facilities
- Disability inclusion and mobility assistance initiatives



## Highlights & Outcomes

-  Improved access to education for 30 students through scholarship support
-  Strengthened community healthcare through 2 fully equipped, functional clinics with hired resources (doctors and nurse) to provide daily healthcare services to Devanahalli Taluk region, Karnataka
-  Enhanced rural livelihoods and livestock health via 6 animal camps
-  Enabled mobility and independence for 8 persons with disabilities
-  Created lasting community assets through a community center and high mast light installation
-  Promoted environmental sustainability through plantation initiatives
-  Enhanced youth employability through introduction of VR-based skill training modules at GTTC college
-  Supply and installation of a 12-meter high mast lighting system at Chanahalli







# LAKE REJUVENATION & COMMUNITY INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECT, HOSUR

The Hosur initiative focuses on ecological restoration and community infrastructure development through the rejuvenation of public spaces and improved environmental systems. The project combines lake restoration, public infrastructure improvement, accessibility measures, and community engagement to strengthen environmental sustainability and public usability within the intervention area.

## Key Interventions

- Lake rejuvenation and ecological restoration activities
- Strengthening of water systems and surrounding infrastructure
- Development of accessible public-use spaces
- Installation of lighting, pathways, and safety infrastructure
- Community engagement and coordination with local stakeholders



## Highlights & Outcomes

-  Successful rejuvenation of a **32.5-acre** lake, restoring its ecological and functional value
-  **Creation** of a safe and accessible public space through a walkable pathway, solar lighting, and CCTV surveillance
-  **Improvement** in water quality and support to groundwater recharge
-  Enhanced community usage and engagement, benefiting **~10,000** residents
-  Completion of a **~2 km** road from Kallupalli Gate to Atthipalli Main Road
-  **Significant improvement** in connectivity, reducing travel time and easing heavy traffic flow
-  Safer and more reliable commuting experience for **~1,00,000** road users
-  **Integrated** approach linking environmental restoration with infrastructure development for wider community impact





# Media & Recognition



25+  
News Publications



50+  
Media Mentions



10K+  
People Reached



Widespread  
Coverage Across Print,  
Digital & Broadcast Media





# Governance



### Ethical Governance Framework

Roots Foundation operates as a registered Society and Section 8 entity with clearly defined structures, ensuring adherence to statutory, financial, and operational compliance standards.



### Board & Leadership Oversight

Strategic oversight is exercised through leadership-led reviews, ensuring alignment of programs with organisational mission, stakeholder expectations, and long-term sustainability goals.



### Independent Assurance Mechanisms

Third-party assessments and independent expert-led evaluations are undertaken across projects to ensure credibility, objectivity, and adherence to best-practice frameworks.



### Risk Management & Internal Controls

Governance systems incorporate financial controls, audit mechanisms, and operational risk mitigation processes to ensure accountability and safeguard resources.



### Responsible Partnerships

Structured collaboration with corporates, government institutions, and ecosystem partners ensures alignment with public systems and responsible scaling of interventions.



### Values-Driven Conduct

Organisational decision-making is anchored in core values of integrity, empathy, accountability, and impact-first approach, embedded across leadership and field operations.



### Transparency & Disclosures

The organisation maintains high standards of transparency through structured reporting of program outcomes, financial utilisation, and stakeholder communication.



### Robust Monitoring & Evaluation Systems

Strengthened M&E architecture incorporating baseline-endline assessments, real-time tracking, and data-driven review mechanisms for continuous improvement.



### Stakeholder-Centric Governance

Programs are co-created with communities and other stakeholders, ensuring participatory planning, responsiveness to grassroots needs, and inclusive decision-making processes.

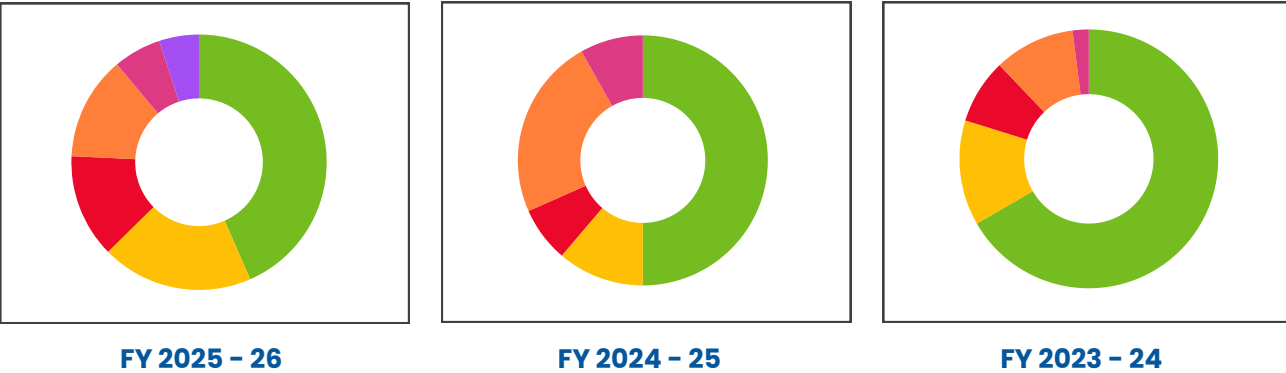


### Sustainable Program Governance

Projects are designed with a 3–4 year implementation horizon to enable behaviour change, institutional strengthening, and long-term community ownership beyond the project lifecycle.

## Financials

### % Contribution for each thematic area to the overall T/O



### Overall Projects' Value

| Year of Project | Overall Projects Value (Rs) | Program Implementation Expenditure(%) | Activities for raising Funds(%) | Administratives & other funds |
|-----------------|-----------------------------|---------------------------------------|---------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| 2023-24         | 75,000,000                  | 78%                                   | 15%                             | 7%                            |
| 2024-25         | 95,000,000                  | 80%                                   | 13%                             | 7%                            |
| 2025-26         | 115,000,000                 | 81%                                   | 12%                             | 7%                            |



# Team

Roots Foundation is led by a diverse and dedicated team that combines youthful energy with seasoned experience. What makes our team unique is that no two people share the same background, qualification, or skillset. Each member brings a distinct perspective shaped by different disciplines, geographies, and lived experiences. This diversity fuels innovation, empathy, and adaptability across all our programs.

Our governance structure ensures transparency and accountability at every level. The Core Leadership Team and Board of Advisors provide strategic direction, while state and field teams drive on-ground execution with precision and purpose.

## Advisory Board



A.P. Sinha



Nidhi Nautiyal



Ankit Bhatia

## Founders



Ritwik Bahuguna



Ridhima Bahuguna

## Vertical Leads



Trapti Moonat



Vikas Gupta



Anirudh Singare



Sonia Singh



# Testimonials

This is what our clients have to say about us



**Ashok Desai**  
Lead EKL CSR Foundation

*On behalf of EKL CSR Foundation, we express our profound appreciation for the outstanding contributions of Roots Foundation in the agriculture training and skill development for farmers. Roots Foundation has been an essential training partner, educating farmers through basic training programs and advanced training in different states.*



**Shri. Lokesh Mishra**  
Deputy Commissioner,  
Khunti

*Utkarsh: Centre of Excellence for Sports, a collaboration between the Khunti District Administration and Roots Foundation, offers world-class training to young athletes. Despite being new, it has delivered exceptional results, enabling students to compete in prestigious tournaments like the Nehru Cup. The dedication of the coaches and the quality of training are commendable, ensuring these athletes will bring pride to Khunti in the future.*



**Saina Nehwal**  
Indian Badminton Player  
and Olympic Medalist

*This initiative (The Sports Lab Initiative) demonstrates a keen understanding of the needs of sportspersons, providing them with essential resources such as this fitness centre in Hisar. This program will go a long way in ensuring a budding athlete gets everything he needs – training, equipment, fitness lessons and recovery protocols.*



**Saurabh Sharma**  
General Manager  
CSV HMIL

*The professionalism, dedication, and expertise Roots brought to the initiatives made a significant difference, and we truly value the synergy we built. Sports Lab is a unique project where Roots Foundation has served as our partner from concept to the implementation stages, also creating measurable impact on the ground.*



# Recognitions

Our efforts have been appreciated time and again.



Indian CSR Awards  
2023



INDIA donates,  
2023



BCC&I Social Conclave, 2nd  
Edition



Chambal Fertilizers & Chemicals Ltd.  
(CFCL),  
Samvartika 7th Edition 2023



BCC&I Social Conclave, 3rd  
Edition



TheCSRUniverse,  
2024



World CSR Day, North  
India  
Leadership Awards, 2024



CSR Times National  
CSR & ESG Award, 2026



# Partnerships & Collaborations

At Roots Foundation, partnerships are the cornerstone of every initiative we undertake. We believe that sustainable impact is achieved when communities, corporations, governments, and knowledge institutions work together toward shared goals.

Over the years, we have partnered with leading corporate organisations, public sector bodies, and development experts who share our commitment to inclusive, scalable, and measurable impact.

















  
Under CSR Initiative

  
EKL CSR Foundation  
(Wholly owned subsidiary of Escorts Kubota Limited)





















and many more...



